TOUCH ENGLISH™
SPEAK WITH CONFIDENCE

STUDENT WORKBOOK · LEVEL 2

Explain a Problem You Are Facing at Work

Explain | OREO | Problem Report

Name: _____ Date: _____

SLIDE 02 Today's goal

By the end of this lesson, I can:

Tell your manager where you are stuck, why, what it affects and what you need, and answer a simple follow-up question.

WHO	You work in the accounts team of a small company in Johor Bahru. Every week you pay the suppliers online.
SITUATION	It is Wednesday morning. Your bank security token is broken, and the bank needs three working days to send a new one: it comes on Monday. Six suppliers are waiting for RM8,400 in total.
NEED	The paper supplier needs RM1,200 by Friday, or they stop your next delivery. The other five can wait until Monday. Mr. Tan has a login too. He has two minutes between meetings.
GOAL	Tell Mr. Tan where you are stuck, why, what it affects and what you need from him. Then answer his questions.

SLIDE 03 Try it first

Mr. Tan asks: "You look worried. Is something wrong with the supplier payments?" Say something for 30 seconds. Then note what you said.

SLIDE 04 A good message

Mei Ling's answer. Mark where each part starts.

Mr. Tan, I'm stuck on the supplier payments. At the moment I can't log in to our bank account. This is because my security token is broken, and the bank needs three working days to send a new one. It comes on Monday. So six suppliers are still waiting for RM8,400. For example, the paper supplier needs RM1,200 by Friday, or they stop our next delivery. What I need is your help. Can you pay the paper supplier from your login today? The other five can wait until Monday. Did I explain that clearly?

O PROBLEM _____

R CAUSE _____

E EFFECT _____

O WHAT I NEED _____

SLIDE 05 Organise it

Kumar tells Mr. Tan about a problem. Put his sentences in order: Problem → Cause → Effect → What I need.

- ☐ What I need is your help. Can you call the factory manager today?
- ☐ That's why the hotel is still waiting. They want 300 towels, and they need our price by 12 tomorrow.
- ☐ The reason is that we are still waiting for the new towel prices from the factory.
- ☐ I'm stuck on the quotation for our new hotel customer.

Write the letter: **O** = Problem · **R** = Cause · **E** = Effect · **O** = What I need

SLIDE 06 Useful language

Tick the expressions you used today.

SAY WHERE YOU ARE STUCK

- [ ] I'm stuck on …
- [ ] The problem is that …
- [ ] At the moment I can't …

GIVE THE CAUSE

- [ ] This is because …
- [ ] The reason is that …
- [ ] It's happening because …

SAY THE EFFECT

- [ ] So …
- [ ] That's why …
- [ ] This means that …
- [ ] For example, …

SAY WHAT YOU NEED

- [ ] What I need is …
- [ ] Can you …?
- [ ] I need your OK to …

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

- [ ] Did I explain that clearly?
- [ ] Shall I say that again?
- [ ] Do you have any questions?
- [ ] Sorry, can you say that again?

SLIDE 07 Connect the ideas

Choose the connector and write the new sentence.

1. I can't log in to the bank account. [because / so / for example,] My security token is broken.

2. The token is broken. [so / but / because] Six suppliers are still waiting.

3. Five suppliers can wait until Monday. [but / because / so] The paper supplier needs the money by Friday.

4. We don't pay the paper supplier by Friday. [because / For example, / If …] They stop our next delivery.

SLIDE 08 Time control

Circle the right form. Why?

1. My security token _____ work any more. (A fact about now)
   - ○ isn't
   - ○ don't
   - ○ doesn't
2. Six suppliers _____ for their money. (Happening now, not finished)
   - ○ are waiting
   - ○ waiting
   - ○ is wait
3. I _____ pay them from my login. (What you cannot do now)
   - ○ can't
   - ○ not can
   - ○ can't to
4. If the new token _____ on Monday, I can pay the other five suppliers. (A condition)
   - ○ comes
   - ○ come
   - ○ coming

SLIDE 09 Present Continuous · can't · basic if

A problem report is about now: what is happening, what you can't do, and what happens if nothing changes.

Six suppliers **are** still **waiting**.

I**'m waiting** for the new token.

I **can't** log in to the bank account.

If we **don't pay** by Friday, they **stop** the delivery.

SLIDE 10

Build your message

Fill each part with your own idea. You will use the same parts in the task.

O PROBLEM

I'm stuck on … At the moment I can't …

R CAUSE

This is because …

E EFFECT

So … For example, …

O WHAT I NEED

What I need is … Can you …? Did I explain that clearly?

SLIDE 11

Problem Report

The speaker reports a problem from a mixed-up card. The manager cannot see the card and fills a Problem Report note: problem, cause, effect, what is needed.

1. Quiet minute: mark each fact on your card P, C, E or N. Round 1 (3:00): report problem → cause → effect → need.
2. Manager: read the listener card at the seat. Fill the note, numbered 1–4 as you hear it. Read back, ask one question.
3. Round 2 (2:00): managers move one seat. Same card, new manager, a shorter report.
4. Round 3 (2:00): new manager. Speakers turn workbook and card over and speak without reading. Then swap roles.

Card 1 · The delivery van

Card 2 · The meeting room

Card 3 · The online orders

Card 4 · The office internet

Problem Report

	ROUND 1	ROUND 2	ROUND 3
Problem			
Cause			
Effect + example			
What they need			

My partner's question or concern, and what I answered:

SLIDE 12 Respond

Mr. Tan asks. Write a short answer to one of these.

1. **Who do I need to pay today, and how much?**
2. **Why can't the paper supplier wait until Monday?**
3. **What about the other five suppliers?**

Start with: **The paper supplier needs … · Because … · They can …**

SLIDE 13 Transfer

You rent a condo unit in JB. The kitchen sink is leaking because a pipe under it is cracked. The cabinet is wet every morning, and yesterday the water reached the floor. You want the owner to send a plumber this week. Phone the owner: explain the problem and say what you need.

I'm calling about … · This is because … · So … For example, … · What I need is …

SLIDE 14 Did I do it?

Be honest. Tick what you did in the task.

- [ ] Says where they are stuck and gives the cause.
- [ ] Says what the problem affects, with one example (a number, a person or a day).
- [ ] Says clearly what they need from the listener.

SLIDE 15

Feedback: how can I improve?

Circle one number for each area. 1 = I need help · 2 = OK · 3 = Good

Problem and cause	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Effect and example	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Saying what I need	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Useful expressions	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Confidence	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3

My improvement action: Next time, I will _____.

WE BELIEVE IN THE POWER OF PRACTICAL SPEAKING TO INSPIRE CONFIDENCE

After class: open the After class review

SLIDE 11

Listener cards: fold or cut

Only the listener looks at a card. It says what to find out and write in the note.

Card 1 · The delivery van

You are Mr. Tan. Write four lines: problem, cause, effect (with one example), what they need. Ask about a line that is empty or not clear. If your note is full, ask: "When is it back?"

Card 2 · The meeting room

You are Mr. Tan. Write four lines: problem, cause, effect (with one example), what they need. Ask about a line that is empty or not clear. If your note is full, ask: "How much is it?"

Card 3 · The online orders

You are Mr. Tan. Write four lines: problem, cause, effect (with one example), what they need. Ask about a line that is empty or not clear. If your note is full, ask: "How long do you need them?"

Card 4 · The office internet

You are Mr. Tan. Write four lines: problem, cause, effect (with one example), what they need. Ask about a line that is empty or not clear. If your note is full, ask: "When can they fix it?"

SLIDE 11

Speaker cards: fold or cut

Only the speaker looks at a card. The listener keeps this page folded.

Card 1 · The delivery van

A café in Skudai needs 20 boxes by Thursday · The workshop needs 2 more days · You can't do this week's deliveries · The van's gearbox is broken · You want to rent a van for 2 days (RM180 a day) · 14 deliveries are waiting

Card 2 · The meeting room

8 customers visit us on Friday at 10 · The room is 33 degrees by 10 a.m. · The aircon compressor is broken; the part comes next week · You can't use the meeting room · You want a meeting room at the hotel next door (RM250)

Card 3 · The online orders

You want 2 part-time packers for 3 days (RM80 a day each) · 60 orders are waiting · You can't send today's orders on time · 3 bad reviews today · 2 of our 4 packers are on medical leave until Monday · The other 2 pack all day

Card 4 · The office internet

A customer needs our price list by 3 p.m. today · The internet company comes on Friday · You can't send emails from the office · The cable outside is damaged · You want a mobile Wi-Fi device today (RM150) · 9 emails are waiting